

# The Study of the Stock Market

*Henry Clews*

Anything that is worth doing is worth doing well. In order to do anything well, one must study the subject thoroughly, not necessarily in books, because books are, except as to the laying down of principles, rather unsatisfactory teachers.

The stock market is a most fruitful and fascinating field of study. It attracts more influential and well-to-do men than any other arena of activity in American life, and of course a great deal of study is bestowed upon it. The reasons why the results of so much study are not always commensurate with the labor and time employed are numerous. Some of them are substantially as follows:—

People have preconceived notions. They are not willing to clear their minds of existing theories and bring themselves down to close dealing with facts. They are apt to base their conclusions on the opinions of others. Now, opinions as to the value of anything are sure to differ, and opinions as to future values differ still more widely, just as the spokes of a wheel are wider apart as you travel away from the hub. When you reach out into the future, you are getting away from the hub of the present. People are usually unwilling to act on conclusions that conflict with their desires, and that involve the acceptance of immediate losses. They resemble